Here is a different case which, many think, the Probability Splitting Rule says just the right thing about.

The poll

I put an argument on the screen, and conduct a poll, asking you to say whether the argument is valid or invalid. You confidently answer "Valid." When the poll results show up, you find to your surprise that you are the only student who answered this way.

What should you say in this case? Why?

Why? We can think of this as a case in which you have many simultaneous disagreements. Supposing for simplicity that everyone initially has credence 1 in her answer, the Probability Splitting Rule would suggest that you should lower your credence in your initial answer to 0.5, then to 0.25, then to 0.125, then to .... a small number.

Does the probability splitting rule have any practical consequences?

Consider any religious, moral, or political view you have. There would seem to be plenty of people who have the same evidence as you, have thought about the issues as much as you, and are as smart as you, who have a view opposite to yours.

This suggests an argument with massive consequences for what you believe about these domains.

the disagreement → agnosticism argument

1. For every moral, political, of religious view you have, you have at least roughly as many epistemic peers who disagree with you as you have epistemic peers who agree with you.
2. The probability-splitting rule.

C. You should not have credence >0.5 about any moral, political, or religious view. (1,2)

Is this argument convincing?

Let's consider instead the possibility that we might reject premise (2), Probability-Splitting.

Is this plausible? Let's look at two arguments against this rule of belief.

The first is that the principle is in a certain way self-refuting. There are plenty of people who have thought about disagreement as much as you have who think that the probability-splitting rule is false.

What, given that, does the probability-splitting rule tell you to think about itself?

So there is a sense in which, given actual beliefs of your epistemic peers, this rule of belief is unstable: it recommends against itself. (In this respect, it is similar to foundationalism, and some of the other negative rules of belief we have discussed.)

Probability-splitting

If you assign P credence N, and come across an epistemic peer who assigns P credence M, then you should change your credence in P to the average of N and M.

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